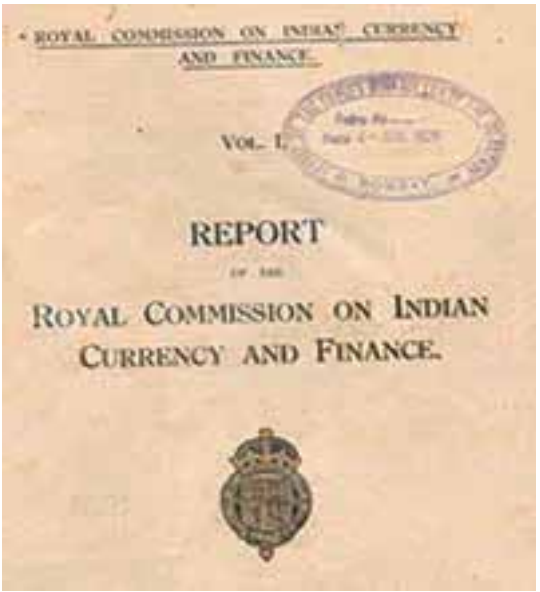
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10.05 Definition of Central Bank

1. "A central bank being generally recognized as a bank which constitutes the apex of the monetary and banking structure of its country and which performs as best as it can, in the national economic interest." - De Kock. He gave a list of seven functions of central bank which are accepted by majority of economists.
2. "It may be defined as an institution charged with the responsibility of managing the expansion and contraction of the volume of money in the interest of the general public welfare." - Kent.
3. "A Central Bank is the bank in any country to which has been entrusted the duty of regulating the volume of currency and credit in that country." - Bank of International Settlement (BIS).

10.06 Origin of RBI

The Imperial Bank of India carried out the note issue and other functions of the central bank. In 1926 the Hilton-Young Commission or the Royal Commission on Indian Currency and Finance (J. M. Keynes and Sir Ernest Cable were its members) made recommendation to create a central bank. As a result, the RBI Act 1934 was passed and RBI launched in operations from April 1, 1935. RBI was established with a share capital of ₹5 crores divided into shares of ₹100 each fully paid up. The entire share capital was owned by private shareholders. Its head office was in Calcutta and moved to Mumbai in 1937.


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After independence, the Government of India passed Reserve Bank (Transfer to Public Ownership) Act, 1948 and took over RBI after paying appropriate compensation to the private shareholders. From January 1, 1949, RBI started functioning as a government owned central bank of India. It had three departments. The RBI was the central bank of Burma until 1947, and the central bank of Pakistan until June 1948.

Emblem of RBI

